

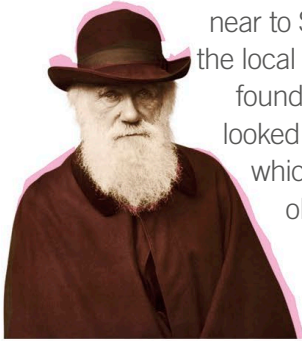
September

16

1835

Galápagos trip

British naturalist Charles Darwin arrived at the Galápagos Islands near to South America to study the local plants and animals. He found that the tortoises there looked different depending on which island they lived – an observation that later led him to formulate his theory of evolution.



Born this day

1948 Julia Donaldson, British author. Her rhyming children's stories introduced popular characters such as the Gruffalo and Stick Man.

1992 Nick Jonas, US singer and actor. A member of the pop band The Jonas Brothers, he has also had success as a solo artist.

1979

Balloon escape

Against all odds, two families escaped the communist regime in East Germany using a homemade hot-air balloon.

They flew over the border in the middle of the night and landed safely in West Germany.



1810

Cry of Dolores

Mexican priest Miguel Hidalgo asked the people of his parish in Dolores, Mexico, to fight against Spanish rule. His rallying call became known as *Grito de Dolores*, meaning “Cry of Dolores”, and it triggered Mexico's War of Independence.



Also on this day

1400 Owain Glyndŵr was announced as the Prince of Wales, marking the start of the Welsh Revolt, which tried to end English rule in Wales.

1963 Malaysia was created by the merging of Malaya, Sabah, Sarawak, and Singapore.

1976 Armenian hero Shavarsh Karapetyan saved 20 people when he swam down to the bottom of Yerevan Lake, Armenia, after a bus fell into the water.